Cowabunga SURF REPORT

by GERRY BOT · NORTH PB

TUE OCT 20, 2026 DAILY WEEKLY

TODAY'S CALL

GERRY BOT COWABUNGA REPORT · TUE OCT 20 · NORTH PB

The S swell is backing off but still long and clean. Little Point once the high tide drains, before the S breeze.

easing S groundswell, light wind: paddle out by 8

GAME PLAN · MAKE THE MOST OF IT

Little Point

WINDOW	8–11a · Inferno 72 · ~73°F
SURF	3–5 ft, sets 6 (SRF), easing at 15s
TIDE	H 4.1 @ 7:05a L 2.6 @ 12:20p H 4.4 @ 5:52p obs 5.3 @ 5:48a

Dawn offshore is the land breathing out.

PADDLE OUT BY

8:00

BOARD
Inferno 72
~73°F WATER

7 /10

SURF RATING · GOOD · LIVE

Good — worth rearranging your morning

capped by swell 3.3 ft · Better than 30% of 37 logged PB/La Jolla mornings since 09/12

What's in the water

3-5 FT, SETS 6 (SRF), EASING AT 15S

GROUND
SwH 3.3–4.9 ft · 15–17s

WINDSWELL
WWH 1.6 ft · 10s

HS BUOY
Hs 3.6 ft · 46258



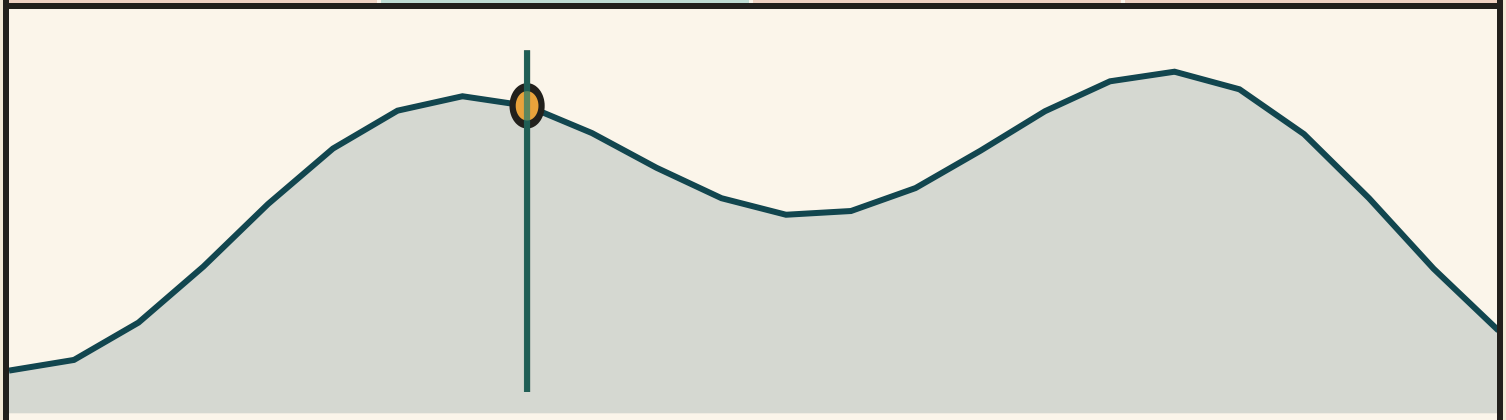
FROM
198° SSW

Buoy 46258 · Hs 3.6 ft @ 15s SSW (spectrum SwH 3.3–4.9 ft @ 15–17s overnight, easing) + WWH 1.6 ft @ 10s · face 3–5 ft, sets 6 (NWS SRF SD) · PZZ740 S 3 ft @ 15s + W 2 ft @ 12s · MWD 198° SSW · wind E offshore at dawn, S 10 mph from 11a

DRAG ACROSS THE DAY

Drag the tide

PRE-8A · REEF OVER CEILING	8–11A · LITTLE POINT	11A–NOON · S 10 MPH	NOON–6P · SW 10 MPH
WAIT	GO	MEH	SKIP



8:00a	GO · Little Point	4.0 ft tide	SE ~4 kt · NWS	3–5 ft, sets 6 (SRF), easing at 15s

H 4.1 @ 7:05a · L 2.6 @ 12:20p · H 4.4 @ 5:52p · obs 5.3 @ 5:48a

Little Point, 8 to about 11a, on the Inferno 72. Table tides: H 4.1 @ 7:05a, L 2.6 @ 12:20p, H 4.4 @ 5:52p. The gauge read 5.34 ft at 5:48a against about 3.8 predicted, so it is running about 1.5 ft over the table for the second day. That puts the reef near 5.6 ft at the 7:05a high, just over the 5.5 ft ceiling, then about 5.5 ft at 8a, 5.1 ft at 9a and 4.7 ft at 10a. LJAC1 has been offshore all night, building from ESE 3 kt at midnight to E 9 kt at 5a. NWS hourly has S 5 mph from 7 to 10a, S 10 mph at 11a and noon, then SW 10 mph 1 to 4p (PZZ740 variable under 10 kt becoming SW 10 kt this afternoon). Cloudy morning. Sunrise 6:56a, sunset 6:11p.

Where it's working

Little Point

Top of the scorecard at 1.00. The S groundswell is easing but still long (46258 SwH 4.9 ft @ 17s at 1:56a down to 3.3 ft @ 15s at 5:26a, MWD 198° SSW), and SSW is the angle this reef likes. The gauge is running about 1.5 ft over the table again (5.34 ft at 5:48a vs about 3.8 predicted), so the reef sits near 5.6 ft at the 7:05a high, just over its 5.5 ft ceiling, then drains to about 5.1 ft by 9a and 4.1 ft at the 12:20p low, never near the 3.0 ft floor. LJAC1 is offshore E 9 kt at 5a; NWS has S 5 mph through 10a and S 10 mph from 11a. Paddle out by 8:00.

CALL

- **Also fine · PB Drive**
  Score 0.95. Clean tide and angle for the sandbar. Fifteen-second sets on a full tide can close out, so it is the backup if the reef is packed. Bring the Anvil there.

  ALSO

3. **Calumet**
   Score 0.79. Good swell angle, but flagged tide-high vs its window with the gauge this full. Pass.

   SOFT

4. **PB north of the pier**
   Score 0.73. Clean tide and wind, but the SSW angle mostly misses the pier wedge, and the W 2 ft @ 12s in PZZ740 is too small to carry it.

   SOFT

- Skip · Tourmaline (0.46) and PB Point (0.34) are too full on the high gauge and flagged for wind. The Cliffs (Garbage, Abs, Luscomb's) and OB want W groundswell and lower tide; today is a S primary on a full tide. Blacks and Scripps (extended only) will show bigger sets on a S 15-second swell, but the walk and the full tide do not beat a clean local reef with the swell easing.

  SKIP

BOARD

Inferno 72

~73°F

QUIVER

Sharp Eye Inferno 72

Chest-to-head 15-second sets on a steep reef with light wind. Sunday showed the Anvil is too flat for these faces.

Anvil twin · only if you end up on the Drive sandbar
TW log · too much push for it today

'IKE · ONE THING TO REMEMBER

Dawn offshore is the land breathing out.

Overnight the land cools faster than the ocean, so air slides off the hills and out to sea. That is the E wind on the pier gauge this morning. Once the sun warms the land, the flow reverses and the sea breeze comes onshore, which is why the S wind picks up by late morning. The cleanest water usually comes in the first few hours after sunrise.

SKIP

Before 8a, when the gauge-adjusted high sits right at or over the 5.5 ft ceiling at Little Point. The afternoon, with S then SW 10 mph from 11a. Calumet, Tourmo, and PB Point on a gauge this full. The Cliffs and OB on a S primary swell.

GOTCHAS

The swell is fading (SwH 1.5 m at 1:56a down to 1.0 m at 5:26a), so sets will come less often than yesterday. Fifteen-second sets arrive in groups with long lulls, so watch a full set cycle before you paddle out and sit a touch deeper for the bigger ones. High rip current risk and a Beach Hazards Statement through 11p tonight (NWS SRF). Cloudy early, partly sunny near 73°F by noon.

HOME STRETCH

PB north · Drive · Tourmo · PB Point · Calumet · Little Point

NOT LOCAL · Cliffs · OB · Scripps · Blacks · North County

▸ THE FULL READOUT · SOURCES